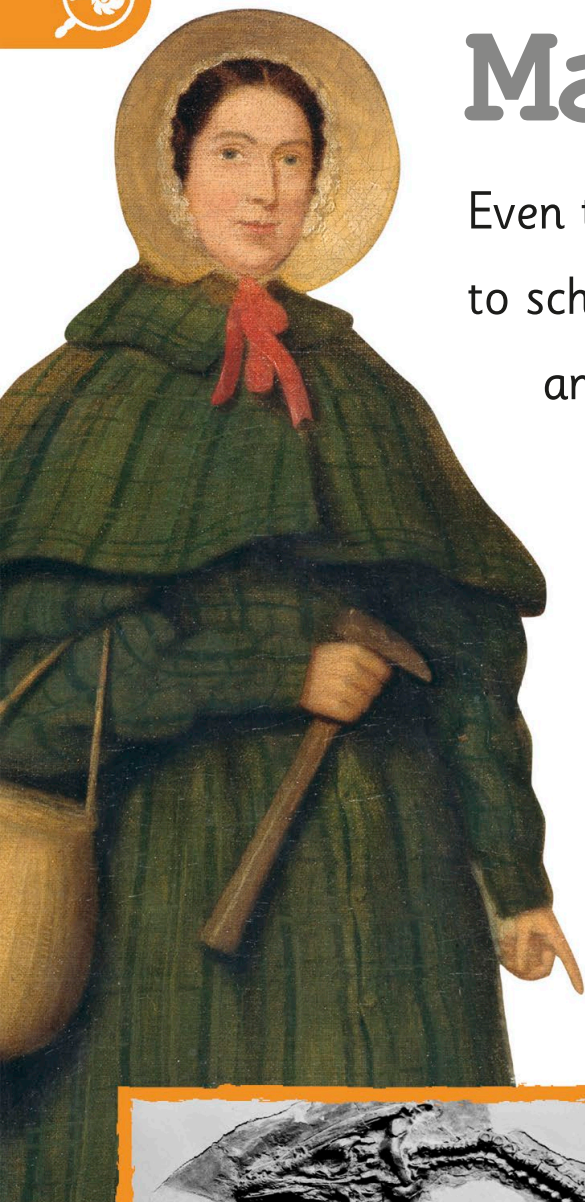




Mary Anning

Even though she was very poor and didn't go to school, Mary Anning made lots of discoveries and became one of the most famous and respected **fossil hunters** ever.

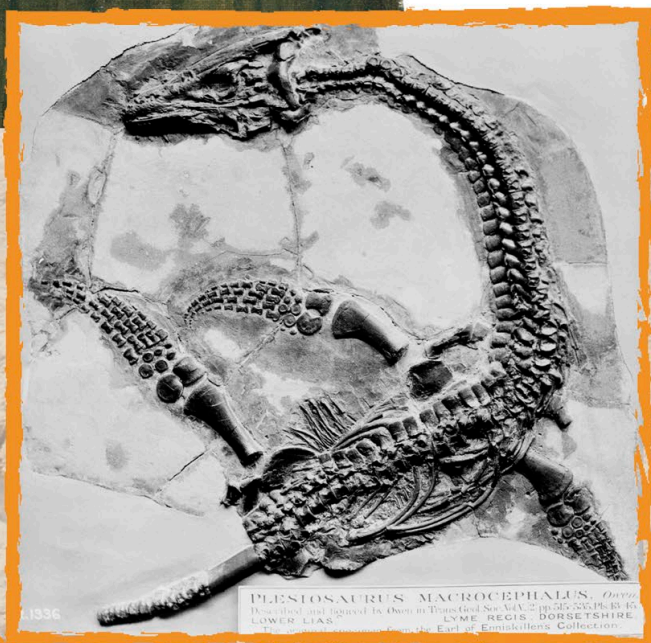
Her first discovery

In 1811, when Mary was just 12, she and her brother Joseph found a huge skull fossil. Mary found the rest of the skeleton and spent a year digging it out. It turned out to be the first **ichthyosaur** fossil ever discovered.

Plesiosaur fossil

Ammonite

Ichthyosaur skull



Lots of firsts

As well as the first ichthyosaur, Mary discovered the first **plesiosaur**, the first **pterosaur**, a giant prehistoric fish, ammonites, and other fossils that had never been seen before.